Brand Sharpener

SPEAKER & PARTNERSHIP GUIDE

Where Marketing Leaders Come Together to Sharpen Their Thinking

Exploring how AI is transforming marketing through practical insights, real-world application, and peer-to-peer learning.

> *"The best ideas are sharpened through conversation."*

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Why Brand Sharpener Exists

Marketing is evolving faster than ever. The best way to keep pace is to learn from one another.

Artificial intelligence is transforming nearly every aspect of marketing—from strategy and research to content creation, customer experience, analytics, and operations. As new technologies emerge and the pace of change accelerates, marketing leaders are continually adapting how they work, lead, and create value.

Brand Sharpener was founded to provide a trusted community where experienced marketing leaders can openly share ideas, explore practical applications, and learn from one another. Our members come together to exchange real-world experiences, challenge conventional thinking, and discuss what's working, what's changing, and what's next.

We Champion the Idea That...

> ***The best ideas are sharpened through conversation.***

We believe meaningful learning happens when experienced professionals share their successes, challenges, lessons learned, and evolving perspectives. That's why Brand Sharpener values authentic conversations, practical demonstrations, and collaborative discussion over polished presentations or perfect answers.

Together, we're building a community where marketing leaders sharpen their thinking, share what they're learning, expand their capabilities, and help shape the future of marketing.

Every conversation is an opportunity to sharpen our thinking.

Brand Sharpener brings together experienced marketing leaders who are curious, collaborative, and committed to learning from one another. Through authentic conversations and practical experiences, our community explores how AI is transforming marketing—and how we can navigate that change together.

A Community of Experienced Practitioners

Brand Sharpener is a community of senior marketing leaders, agency executives, AI strategists, consultants, founders, and research professionals representing brands, agencies, technology companies, consulting firms, and research organizations. While our backgrounds and experiences are diverse, we are united by a shared curiosity, a willingness to exchange ideas, and a commitment to continuous learning.

Learning Through Shared Experience

We believe the most valuable learning comes from practical experience. Our members openly share real-world applications, lessons learned, emerging ideas, and honest perspectives that help all of us grow as marketing leaders. We value collaboration over competition, discussion over presentation, and practical application over theory.

Ideas We Explore Together

Our conversations explore practical ideas and emerging trends that marketing leaders can apply immediately.

TOPIC	EXAMPLES
AI & GenAI	Practical AI applications, workflow transformation, prompt engineering, governance, emerging tools, and implementation lessons
Brand Strategy	Positioning, portfolio strategy, storytelling, differentiation, and transformation
Consumer Insights	Research, segmentation, journey mapping, and turning insights into action
Marketing Operations	MarTech, process improvement, campaign operations, budgeting, and organizational effectiveness
Content & Creative	Content strategy, creative development, storytelling, creator partnerships, and campaigns
Analytics & Measurement	Attribution, dashboards, experimentation, KPIs, and business impact
Search & Discovery	SEO, GEO, discoverability, search behavior, and content optimization
Product & Innovation	Commercialization, go-to-market strategy, innovation, and customer adoption

Don't see your topic listed? We'd love to hear your idea—these examples are meant to inspire discussion, not limit it.

What Inspires Meaningful Conversation

The sessions that resonate most with our community are interactive, practical, and discussion-driven. Members appreciate presentations that demonstrate real business applications, share implementation lessons, encourage open dialogue, and inspire continued learning.

Join the Conversation

Together, we're building a community where marketing leaders sharpen their thinking, share what they're learning, expand their capabilities, and help shape the future of marketing.

Present at Brand Sharpener

We're always looking for experienced practitioners who are passionate about sharing ideas, practical experiences, and emerging perspectives with our community. Our most successful sessions are conversational, practical, and interactive—focused on sharing real-world experiences that help fellow marketing leaders learn, adapt, and grow.

Format	45–60 minute virtual presentation
Style	Interactive discussion and audience Q&A
Audience	Experienced marketing, brand, insights, and business leaders
Promotion	Featured across Brand Sharpener communications and LinkedIn

Meet the Founders

Stephen Griffiths FOUNDER

Managing Director

Director of Strategic Insights at Ameriprise Financial Services and a recognized insights leader focused on helping teams use data, research, and AI more effectively. Stephen also co-founded the Insights Career Network, a large volunteer-run community for market research and UX professionals, reflecting the community-building spirit behind Brand Sharpener.

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Krysti Horvat CO-FOUNDER

Events & Membership Director

Creative designer and marketer whose work bridges brand, design, marketing, and emerging AI applications. Krysti brings a practitioner perspective to Brand Sharpener and a strong interest in how marketers can apply new tools in practical ways while continuing to learn from one another.

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Jonathan Erickson CO-FOUNDER

Community & Communications Director

Insights and strategy leader whose work explores culture, research methodology, and the role of AI in strategic decision-making. Jonathan also co-founded the Third Culture Strategy & Insights Collective and brings a strong point of view on peer learning, cultural intelligence, and choosing the right tools for the problem.

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Mary Rodgers CO-FOUNDER

Speaker & Partnership Director

Senior marketing executive with deep experience in brand strategy, go-to-market leadership, product commercialization, consumer insights, integrated marketing, and AI-enabled marketing. Mary has led marketing for major consumer and durable-goods businesses and brings a practical, business-outcome-focused perspective to the Brand Sharpener community.

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Roxanna Kassamkara CO-FOUNDER

Brand Director

A Brand Sharpener co-founder who helps shape a community built around shared learning, candid discussion, and practical application. Her involvement reflects the group's commitment to bringing different practitioner perspectives together as marketing and AI continue to evolve.

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Justin Mancari CO-FOUNDER

Tech & Tools Director

Marketing and business development leader with experience spanning digital strategy, search, technology, and growth. Justin writes and speaks about the changing search landscape and how marketers can increase visibility across an expanding mix of channels, bringing a practical growth perspective to Brand Sharpener conversations.

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Whether you're presenting, partnering, or joining—we'd love to hear from you.